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Attributes of Self-Existence

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Attributes of Self-Existence

“God said to Moses, ‘I AM that I AM.’”

— Exodus 3:14

Before God is known as Creator, Judge, or Savior, He is known as the One who is. That is where this chapter begins.

Everything we meet in the world has a history. A mountain rose. A star ignited. A child was born. Every creature can be asked, “Where did you come from?” and some answer can be given. God cannot be asked that question in the same way. He did not emerge from a prior cause. He was not assembled from older materials. He does not borrow life from the universe He made. His name in the wilderness is not a title we gave Him. It is the disclosure of His being: **I AM**.

This chapter considers five attributes that belong to that revelation.

- **Self-Existent** — His being needs no source.
- **Eternal** — His being has no beginning and no end.
- **Transcendent** — He is distinct from the world He made, even as He sustains it.
- **Spirit** — He is not bound by matter, place, or form.
- **Unchanging** — He does not grow, diminish, or become; He is already complete.

These are not five extra facts about a familiar God. They are the first truths of His majesty. If they are neglected, the rest of the book will still sound devout, yet God will slowly take the shape of a larger human being—powerful, kind, and wise, but still one more actor inside the world. Self-existence will not allow that reduction. He is not an item in the inventory of what exists. He is the living Source from whom existence itself proceeds.

This category answers a question the other chapters cannot answer: Who is God in Himself, apart from us? Sovereignty will speak of how He rules. Holiness will speak of how He makes right. Love will speak of how He gives Himself. Those movements assume a God who already is. Here we stand still long enough to behold that prior reality. He would still be God if no world had been spoken into being. Creation did not complete Him. Time did not start Him. Matter does not contain Him. Change does not improve Him.

To meditate on these attributes is therefore an act of humility and of rest. Humility, because every breath we take is received. Rest, because the One who holds us is not Himself held by anything. Prayer becomes less a demand upon a needy deity and more communion with the Fountain who lacks nothing. Faith becomes less a wager on a changing mood and more trust in the God who remains.

The attributes that follow take each of these five truths in turn. They are meant to be read slowly. Let Scripture name Him. Let the mind bow. Let the heart learn again that the first gift of knowing God is not a task He assigns, but the wonder of the One who simply is.

God Is Self-Existent

He depends on nothing; He is the great “I AM.”

Because God is self-existent, I will fully depend on Him, knowing nothing, including me, exists apart from Him.

God Is Eternal

He has no beginning and no end.

Because God is eternal, I will rest secure, knowing He will never cease to be.

God Is Transcendent

He is high above creation, distinct from it, yet holding it.

Because God is transcendent, I will worship Him as One above and beyond all His creation.

God Is Spirit

He is invisible, personal, and unbound by matter or place.

Because God is Spirit, I will come to Him in any place and at any hour.

God Is Unchanging

His character and purposes remain forever the same.

Because God is unchanging, I will trust His character when everything else is shifting.

These attributes of self-existence reveal the majestic otherness of God. He is the Fountainhead of all existence, complete in Himself within the perfect fellowship of the Trinity. The God we worship is not fragile, local, or evolving. He simply is—and He remains who He is forever.

To dwell here is to be comforted by His gracious invitation to know and walk with Him. In a world that constantly changes and fails us, we find security in the God who has always been fully sufficient, who is near to us by His Spirit, and who generously sustains every breath we take. The One who inhabits eternity is also the One who draws near in Christ and holds His people without fail.

Go Deeper:

- >> [God Is Self-Existent](#)
- >> [God Is Eternal](#)
- >> [God Is Transcendent](#)
- >> [God Is Spirit](#)
- >> [God Is Unchanging](#)

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In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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